Bonang N. Seoela

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Personal Information

Citizenship: United States and Kingdom of Lesotho.
Hobbies: Road and trail biking, soccer, and tennis.

Education

Indiana University Bloomington, Bloomington, IN — Aug 2022 – May 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Economics

Boise State University, Boise, ID — Aug 2018 – May 2020
M.S. in Economics

The College of Idaho, Caldwell, ID — Aug 2014 – May 2018
B.S. in Mathematics and Physics; Minor in Business

Research Fields

Primary: International Trade; Environmental and Energy Economics.
Secondary: Spatial Economics; Labor Economics; Computational Macroeconomics.

Teaching Experience

Indiana University Bloomington, Department of Economics

- **Associate Instructor** (*full teaching responsibility*), ECON 303 Survey of Intern. Economics — Fall 2024; Spring 2026
- **Teaching Assistant**, ECON-B 251 Principles of Microeconomics — Fall 2023; Spring 2024; Fall 2025

Boise State University, Department of Economics

- **Teaching Assistant**, ECON 303 Intermediate Microeconomics — Spring 2020
- **Teaching Assistant**, ECON 511 Advanced Microeconomic Theory I — Fall 2019
- **Teaching Assistant**, ECON 455 Behavioral Economics — Fall 2019

Job Market Paper

"Environmental Regulation, Firm Export Dynamics, and Welfare: Evidence from Mexico's Air-Quality Programs" (Link to most recent version)

Air quality regulations often target pollution where exposure is highest, creating spatial differences in both compliance costs and environmental benefits. This paper studies one such intervention, Mexico's ProAire air-quality programs, and their effects on manufacturing emissions, firm trade, and consumer welfare. I combine the staggered rollout of ProAire across municipalities from 2011 to 2020 with linked firm-level data. I first show that the decline in Mexican manufacturing emissions intensity between 2005 and 2018 was driven mainly by within-industry technique changes, which account for 88 percent of the reduction. After ProAire adoption, reported CO_2 emissions among RETC-reporting firms fall by 11 percent. Trade adjustment occurs primarily through the extensive and intensive margins of exporting. Export entry changes little, export exit rises by 2.8 percentage points, and export sales among continuing exporters fall by 9.5 percent, while imports among continuing importers rise by 18 percent. I then evaluate the welfare implications of spatially targeted regulation through a quantitative spatial model with heterogeneous firms, pollution-intensive production, international trade, atmospheric transport, and worker sorting. I find that ProAire lowers output by 0.07 percent, while welfare rises by 0.099 percent.

Journal Publication

1. Seoela, Bonang N. (2022). "Efficacy of monetary policy in a currency union? Evidence from Southern Africa's Common Monetary Area." *Quantitative Finance and Economics*, 6(1), 35–53. DOI.

Work in Progress

1. **"Energy Price Shocks along the Global Supply Chain: The Effects of Fossil Fuel Reforms in Mexico"** — *Draft in progress*

   This paper studies Mexico's transition from implicit fossil-fuel subsidies to fuel excise taxation and carbon pricing. I combine establishment-level Economic Censuses data with emissions records, official fuel-tax schedules, and pre-reform sectoral fuel use. The empirical design uses predetermined energy intensity and fuel composition to measure exposure to the 2014 tax schedule. I then develop a multi-sector, multi-country general equilibrium model with input–output linkages and international trade to trace supply-chain effects on emissions, output, exports, welfare, and carbon leakage.

2. "*Does Minimum Wage Increase Formal Employment? Tax Incentives and Informality at Mexico's Northern Border*" *Draft in progress*
3. *Disrupted Routes, Missing Relationships: Transport Shocks and Firm-to-Firm Trade*
4. *Impact of Air Quality Regulations on Entrepreneurial Activity* (with Samia Islam, 2020).

Fellowships and Awards

Witney/LeMar Fellowship, Indiana University	Spring 2026
Tobias Center Research Support Grant, Indiana University	Fall 2025
UC Berkeley/Sloan Summer School Travel Award	Aug 2025
Best Graduate Student Paper, Indiana University	Spring 2025
Southern Region Educational Board Doctoral Scholar, Indiana University	2022 – 2027
John J. and Ethel C. Chapman Graduate Economics Fellowship	2019 – 2020
Economics Department Signature Student, Boise State University	Fall 2019

Research Experience

Boise State University. Boise, ID. Graduate Research Assistant — Aug 2018 – May 2020

Professional Experience

Congressional Budget Office. Washington, DC. Associate Analyst Intern — May 2024 – Aug 2024

Idaho Department of Labor. Twin Falls, ID. Labor Economist — Aug 2020 – Jul 2022

Albertsons Companies. Boise, ID. Data Science Intern — May 2024 – Aug 2024

Policy Briefs and Media

Selected policy reports

1. "Why are home prices across Idaho Cities rising faster than the national average?" IDOL, 2022. Link.
2. "Idaho's center of population continues westward shift." IDOL, 2022. Link.
3. "Idaho beef industry showing marked recovery." IDOL, 2021. Link.
4. "A closer look at Idaho's financial activities sector in the past decade: A shift-share analysis." IDOL, 2020. Link.

In the Media

"Dept. of Labor report: Idaho needs more entry-level homes," *Idaho Business Review*, August 2022. Link.

Relevant Skills

Programming and Software: Python, R, Stata, SQL, MATLAB, GIS
Languages: Sesotho (native), English (fluent), Spanish (Beginner).

Conferences, Seminars, and Workshops

Tobias Center Research Symposium (2026); BREAD Conference on Development Economics (2026); EIIT Conference (2026); IUB Microeconomics Seminar (2026); AIER Classical Liberalism and The Market Seminar (2026); UC Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics (2025); Hoosier Economics Conference (2025); EIIT Conference (2024)

Academic Service

Discussant: EIIT Conference, Indiana University Bloomington (2026).
"Elsewhere in North America: How U.S. Tariffs on China Boosted Mexico's Manufacturing Employment and Output", Hale Utar (Grinnell College)

Affiliations

National Economic Association, Member
National Association for Business Economics, Member

References

Volodymyr Lugovskyy, Ph.D.
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